Character Creation

You're going to want to make a copy of the Character Sheet Template for this.

Its a good idea to discuss what you're planning to play with your fellow players, and balancing your party, but be careful that nobody is forced into playing something they don't want to. Once you have a character concept and are ready to move to creation, you're going to want to follow these steps:

Pick your class, and put down its base stats on your sheet (see Ability Checks for how to handle CHA/INT), optionally increasing or decreasing WT by up to 3. If the class has a starting Skill, put it in the first slot of your Skills. If they have multiple choices for Skills, pick one. Classes give you Proficiency in one or more weapons, granting D Rank in one weapon of your choice and E Rank in any others, if you have multiple. Some classes with multiple Proficiencies can also give one up to make the other C Rank, or give up their D Rank (but not proficiency) for an additional proficiency. All Proficiencies start at 0 wEXP. All units start with 1,500 Gold to buy equipment with. Buy as much as you want within that limit, and add it to your sheet. All units, regardless of if they have a starting Class Skill or not, also start with a Generic Skill, which you may also add.

The following two aspects of character creation can be VERY different from campaign to campaign, so it is advisable to tailor-make your characters for campaigns and their rules, rather than adapting and remaking existing ones. At the same time, you should practice making a character or two with the default rules.
By default, characters get 5 bonus points to assign to their stats, permanently increasing them, but cannot put more than 2 points into one stat. Units can put these points into HP, STR, MAG, DEF, RES, DEX, SPD, LUK, CON, CHA and INT. HP and LUK are increased by 2 per point put in. After this is your Growth Rates. Growth Rates determine what stats increase when you level up, and you are free to tailor them to your needs. All Growth Rates start at 10%, and the player is given 245 Points to assign to them, increasing them further, as well as an additional 25 Points that can only be assigned to CHA or INT. Growth Rates cap at 80% for HP, and 60% for all other stats, but increases from items and the like can break these caps. By the end, you should have 370 total Growth Points assigned, accounting for the 10% basis. Additionally, alongside bonus points and Growths, units can assign a Boon and Bane to their stats. If a unit applies a Boon, they MUST apply a Bane, and vice versa. Boons and Banes increase/decrease a stat by 1, increase/decrease it's Growth Rate by 5%, and increase/decrease it's stat cap by 2. For HP and LUK, they increase/decrease the stat by 2 and increase/decrease the cap by 5. You cannot Boon/Bane the same stat, cannot Boon/Bane CHA or INT, and cannot Bane a stat that is 0. When leveling up, you roll a D100 for each stat, and if the roll is equal to or lower than your Growth Rate for that stat, it increases by 1. In the event a Growth Rate exceeds 100%, its increase is guranteed every level, with any amount above 100% being a chance to increase by 2.

With the mechanics out of the way, make sure to use the Character Profile tab to write down your character's lore, personality, etc. as well as your own notes, boundaries and thoughts as a player.

Leveling and Promotion

As discussed in the section above, units increase their stats through Leveling up, which is done by obtaining Experience Points. EXP is primarily obtained through combat and using Staves or Skills (see the EXP tab for just how much you get!), but can be given out by the GM as they see fit, such as for good roleplay. Units start at 0 EXP and require 100 to Level up, carrying over any excess EXP over 100 and Leveling up. When you Level up, you obtain Ability Points (see Ability Checks), then roll your stat growths after speccing your AP.

Once a unit has reached Level 20 and Levels up again, it does not level up as normal, but instead Promotes (Units may also promote early through the use of special Promotion items). When Promoting, the unit chooses 1 of the 3 Tier 2 classes available to it to become, and upon making this choice adds that Promotion's stat gains to their character's stats. The unit also gains a new Skill, either the Promotion Skill of the class chosen, or a Generic Skill of the unit's choice. After a unit reaches Tier 2, it can obtain their class's Occult Skill through the use of an Occult Scroll, or naturally by reaching Level 50. Promotion typically grants new Proficiencies, and sometimes Special Qualities. New Proficiencies are D Rank when promoting to Tier 2, C Rank when promoting to Tier 3, and B rank when promoting to a Heaven Seal class. When Promoting, each of the unit's Growth Rates also increases by 5%, breaking caps if necessary. Alternatively, players may reallocate any portion of the gained 40%, adding more than 5% to a growth, though they are still only allowed to break a growth cap by 5%. They are also able to reallocate 40% of their existing growths in addition to the 40% gained on promotion, though the GM may change how much they may reallocate from their stats. Promoted units are Level 21, and continue leveling until they reach level 41, at which point they will promote to a Tier 3 Promoted class, repeating the previous process. When promoting to Tier Three, they learn their Mastery Skill, but may not replace it with a Generic.

Laguz, Manakete and Taguel don’t 'promote' like Beorc do upon reaching a certain level, instead they continue leveling up as normal, but DO gain their Laguz/Manakete/Taguel Skill, which act basically like Promotion Skills, and can be swapped for Generics. After that, Non-Beorc can get their Occult Skills just like Beorc can, with the use of an Occult Scroll or at Level 50. Similarly. reaching level 41 grants Non-Beorc their Mastery Skill.